

IRON
CROWN
COMICS



No. 7
\$4.99 US

THE SILVER POOL

SONGS OF THE LOST

"THEY SING
SO WE REMEMBER.
THEY RISE
SO WE NEVER
FORGET."



NELL



THE VOICES...
HOW MUCH
FARTHER?

CLOSER.

THE STONE
THINGS.
THEIR ECHOES
GROW BOLD.



IT'S LIKE
THE WALLS
ARE...

...HOLDING
ITS BREATH.

MURMUR
MURMUR
MURMUR

NO.

IT'S
LISTENING.

THEN LET
IT HEAR
US FIRST.



MURMUR

MURMUR

THE AZRAEL MANSION
OUTER GATE

STILL.
AFTER ALL
THIS TIME...

IT
RECOGNIZES
NO ONE.



GROOOO
OOO
OONN



IMPRESSIVE.
NOTHING
BUILT LIKE
THIS ANYMORE.
NOTHING.



RRRRMMMMMM



BEST KIND
OF WELCOME.



No pews.

No altar.

Just a basin of
silver and the
voices of the
drowned.

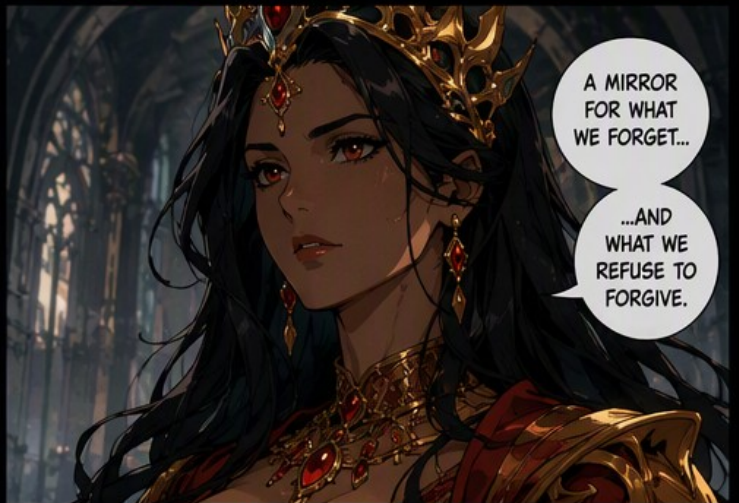


WHAT
IS THIS
PLACE?



A MIRROR
FOR WHAT
WE FORGET...

...AND
WHAT WE
REFUSE TO
FORGIVE.



THEY'RE
SINGING.

THOUSANDS
OF VOICES.

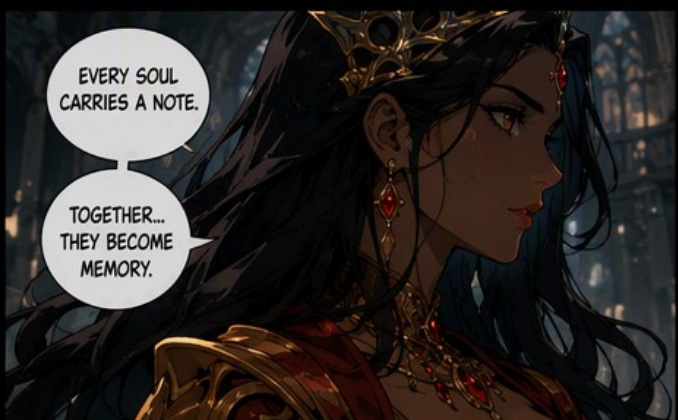


A HUNDRED
ERAS, ALL
IN ONE
CHORUS...

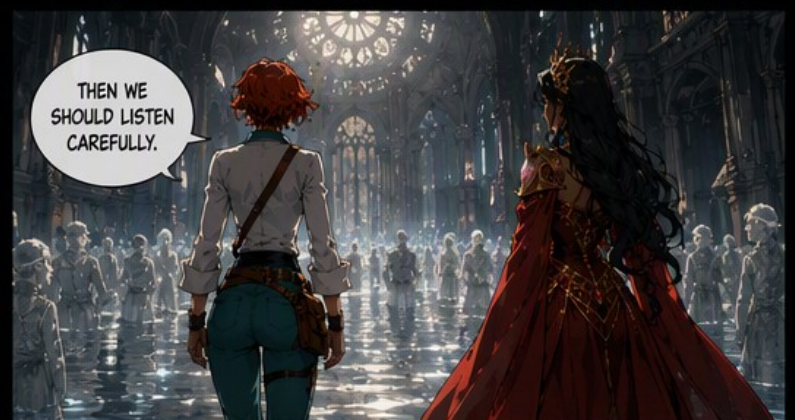


EVERY SOUL
CARRIES A NOTE.

TOGETHER...
THEY BECOME
MEMORY.



THEN WE
SHOULD LISTEN
CAREFULLY.



THE SUNKEN NAVE.
FILLED WITH SILVER.
FILLED WITH ECHOES.



IT'S
OLDER
THAN THE CITY
ITSELF.

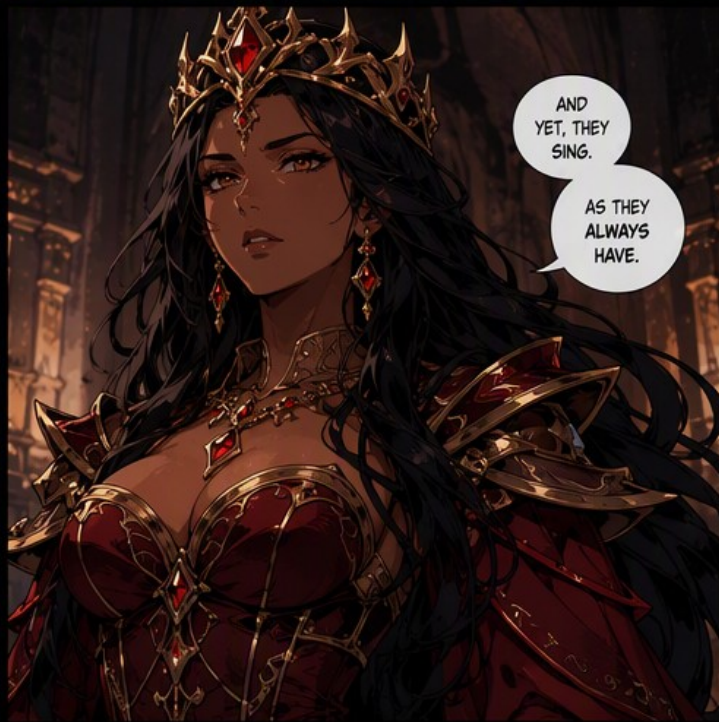
OLDER THAN
THE EMPIRE.

OLDER THAN
MEMORY.



AND
YET, THEY
SING.

AS THEY
ALWAYS
HAVE.



WHAT
HAPPENS
WHEN THE SONG
ENDS?

THEN WE
WILL SEE WHAT
REMAINS.



UNTIL THEN...

LET'S
MAKE SURE
WE'RE WORTH
REMEMBERING.





THE CHOIR...

THOUSANDS
OF VOICES,

OVERLAPPING.

A HARMONY
TOO VAST
TO HOLD
MEANING.



BUT THEN—

ONE SMALL
FREQUENCY.



A CLEAR THREAD
THROUGH THE NOISE.



♪ hummm...
lalalalalalala...

SIMPLE.

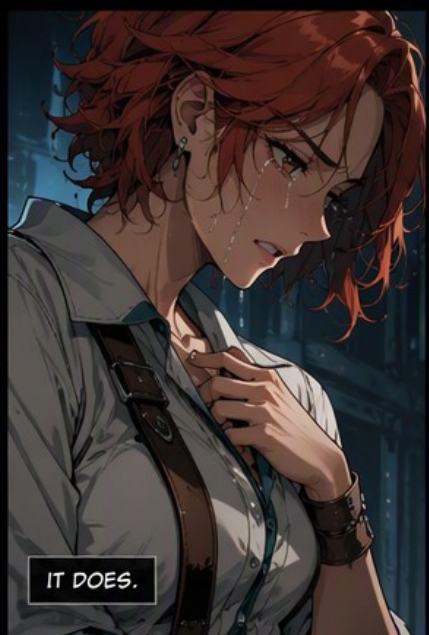
PURE.

CHILDLIKE.

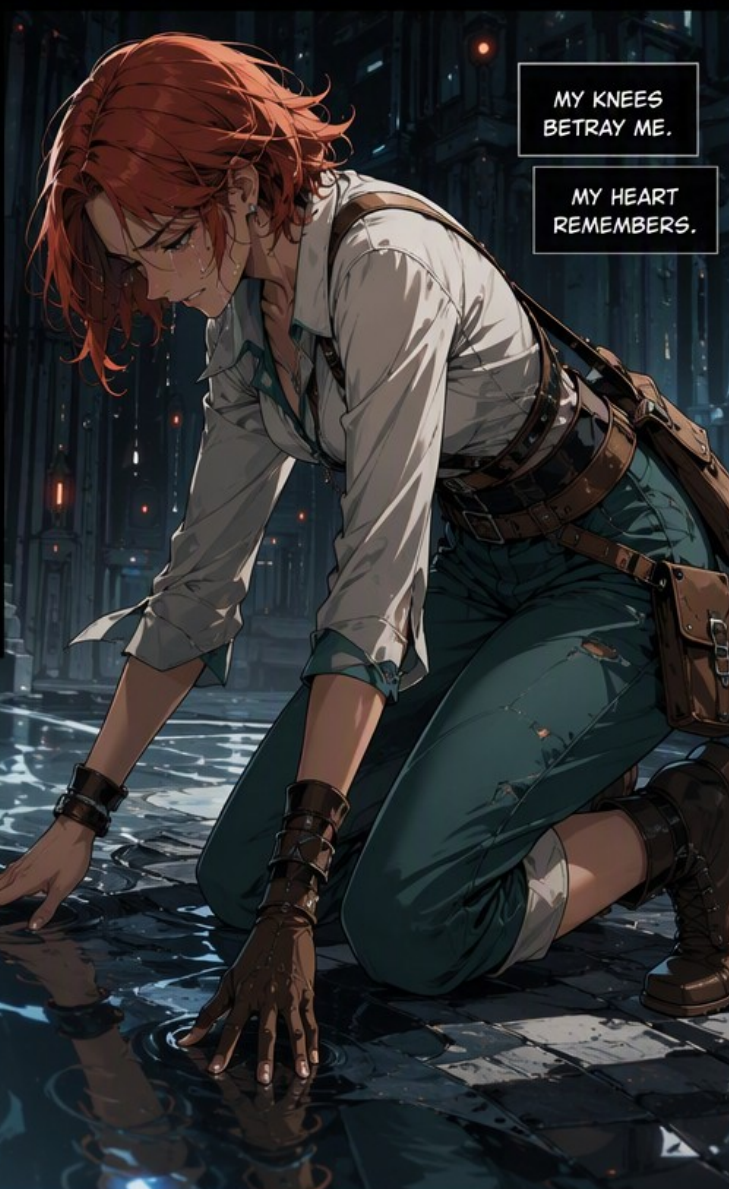


IT SHOULDN'T
BREAK ME.

AND YET—



IT DOES.

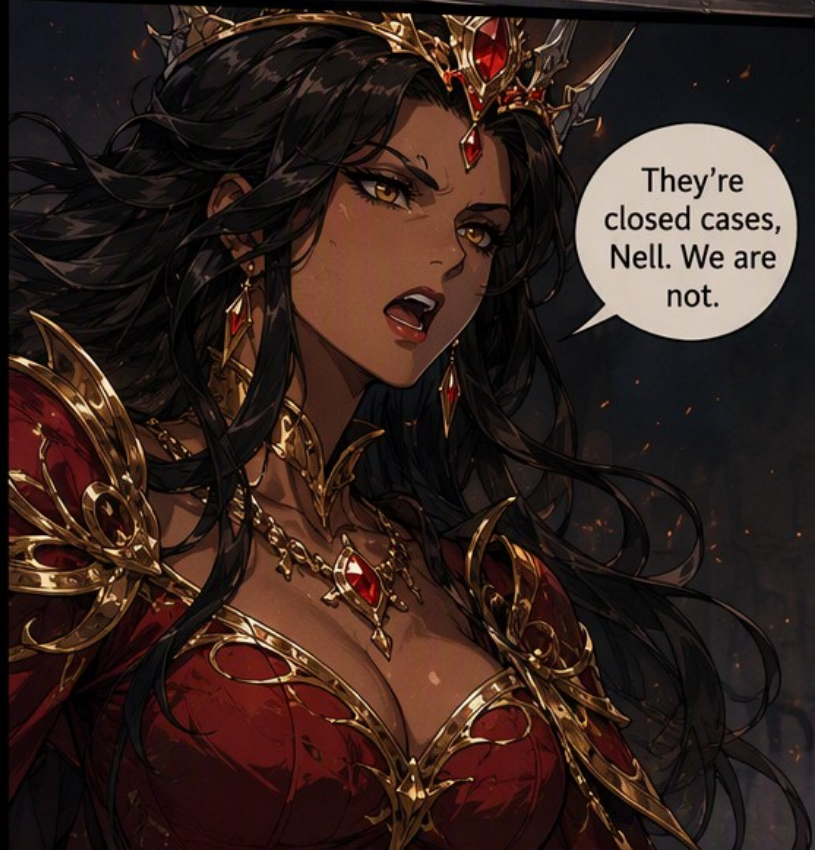


MY KNEES
BETRAY ME.

MY HEART
REMEMBERS.

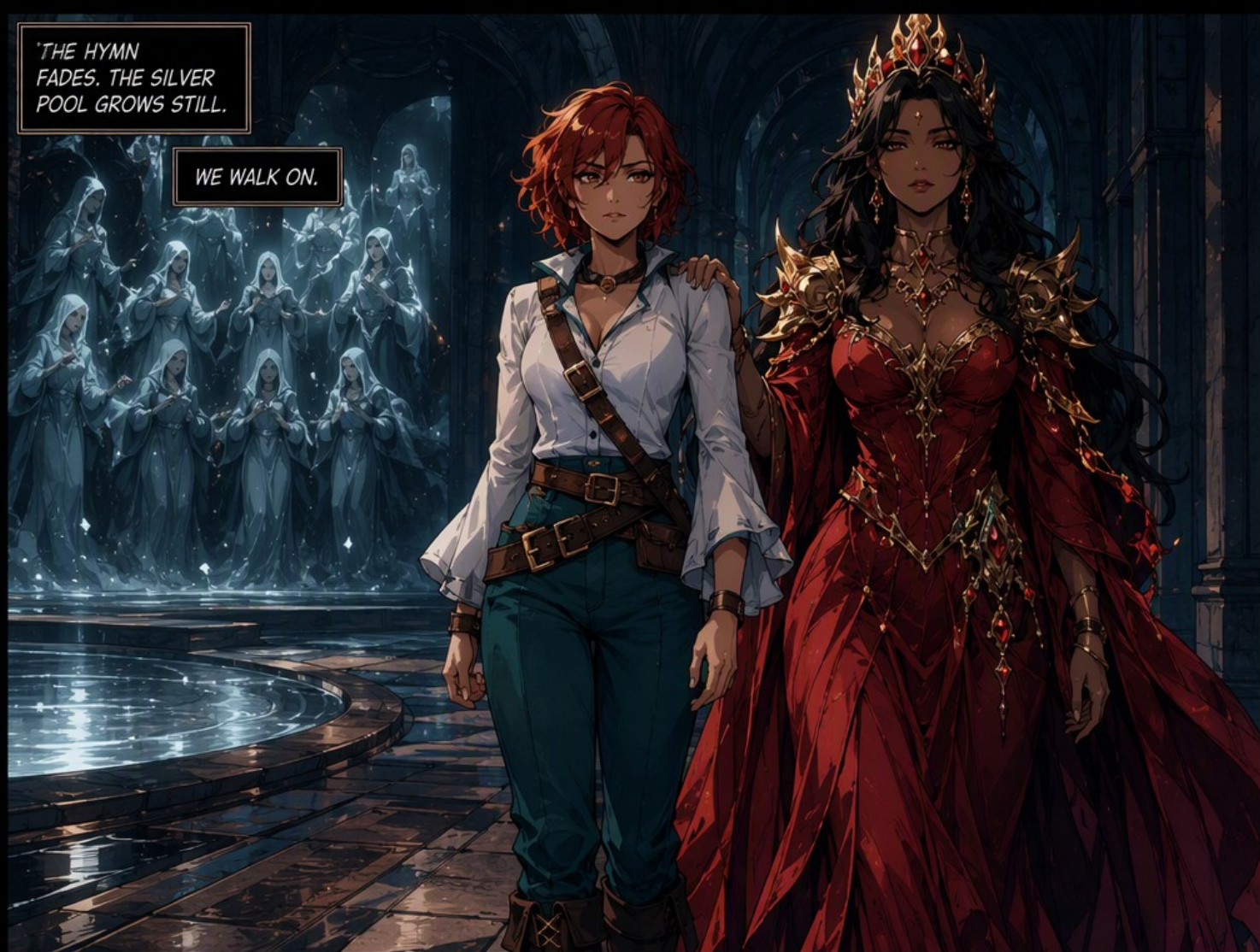


♪ hummm...
lalalalalalala...



THE HYMN
FADES. THE SILVER
POOL GROWS STILL.

WE WALK ON.



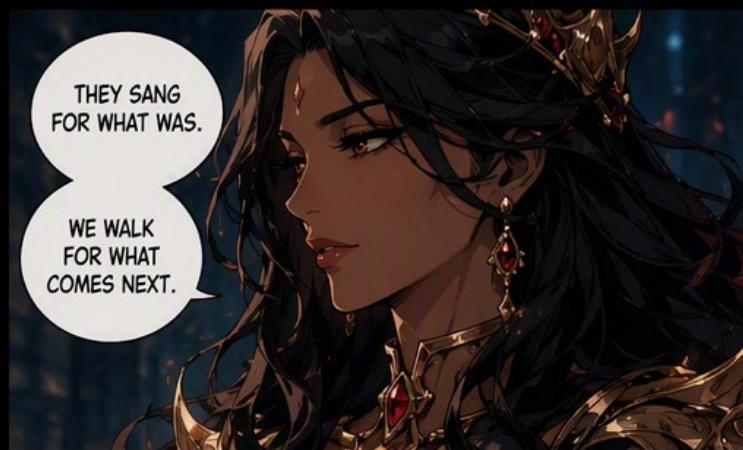
THAT...
WASN'T JUST
AN ECHO.

THAT WAS
THEM.



THEY SANG
FOR WHAT WAS.

WE WALK
FOR WHAT
COMES NEXT.



SHE GLANCES BACK
ONCE. JUST ONCE.

THEN FORCES
HER FEET
FORWARD.

NOT EVERYTHING
SHOULD BE
REMEMBERED.



THE GATE
CLOSES.

THE SONG
IS GONE.

ONLY SILENCE
REMAINS.

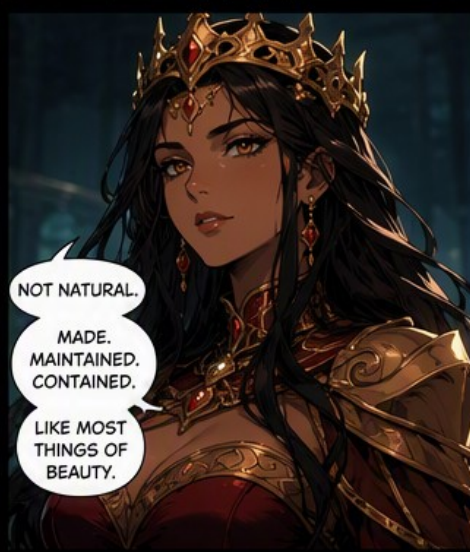




HIGHER.
THE AIR
GROWS HEAVIER
THE CLOSER WE
GET.



THAT
AQUARIUM...
IS THAT
NATURAL?



NOT NATURAL.
MADE.
MAINTAINED.
CONTAINED.
LIKE MOST
THINGS OF
BEAUTY.



AND WE
ARE THE ONLY
ONES ALLOWED
THIS HIGH.



IT'S
BEAUTIFUL.
...IN A
SUFFOCATING
SORT OF WAY.

BEAUTY
IS OFTEN
A GENTLE
PRISON.

WE ARE
ITS WILLING
PRISONERS.

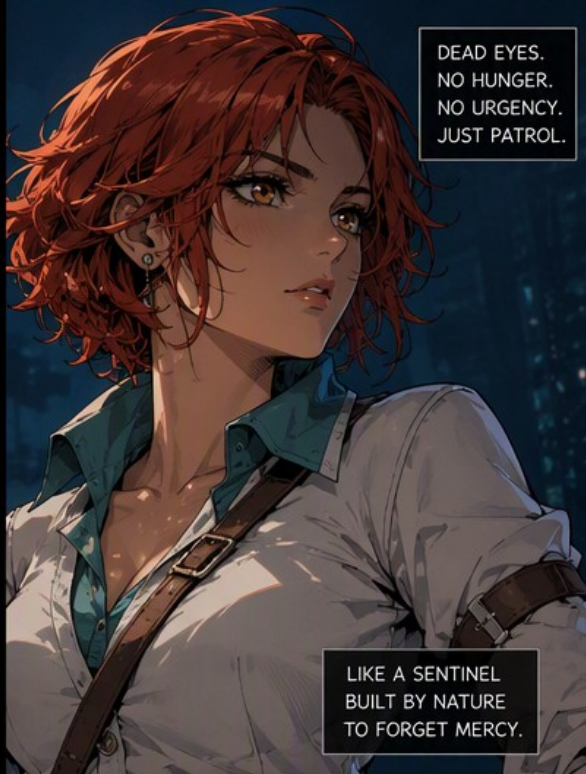


DEPTH: 42 METERS
TANK 7 - OMEGA



THIRTY FEET OF
PERFECT, SILENT
INDIFFERENCE.

DEAD EYES.
NO HUNGER.
NO URGENCY.
JUST PATROL.



LIKE A SENTINEL
BUILT BY NATURE
TO FORGET MERCY.

TREASURE WITHOUT
OWNERSHIP.
BEAUTY WITHOUT
WITNESS.



AND ME...

IT MOVES IN
PERFECT FIGURE-EIGHTS.
A REMINDER:

JUST ANOTHER
OBSERVER.



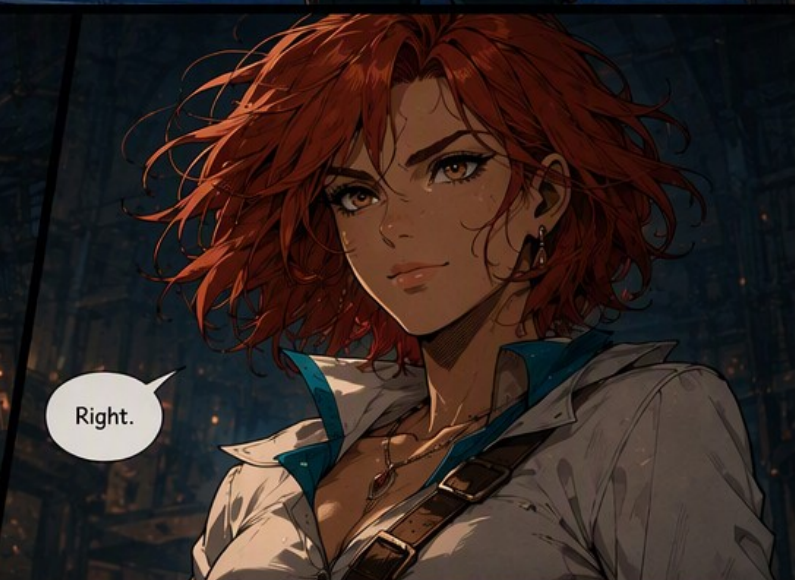
SOME THINGS AREN'T
MEANT TO BE
INTERFERED WITH.

TANK 7
OMEGA
STATUS
STABLE



RECOGNITION IS ITS
OWN KIND OF DEFEAT.





CALEO DRAGONIS
—EMPRESS OF FLAME—

BE STILL.
LET THE HEAT
LEAVE YOU.





THE GUARDIAN
OF THESE DEPTHS
DOESN'T LIKE
UNINVITED GUESTS.

LUCKILY, I DIDN'T
COME EMPTY-HANDED.



THERE IT IS.



?!

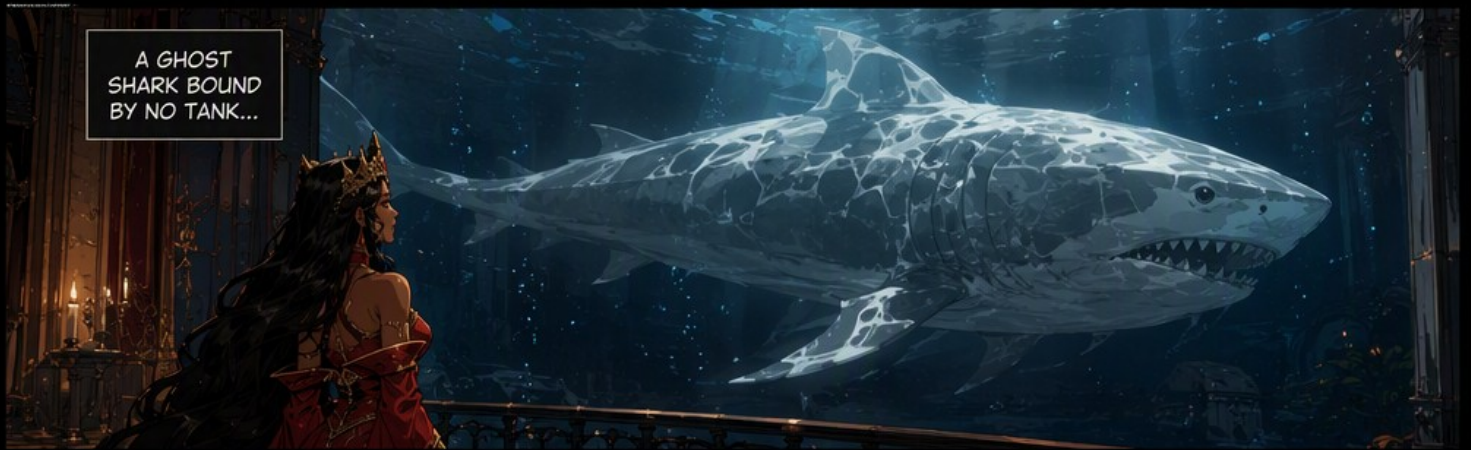


IT'S
WARM.

AND IT'S
PULSING.



IT'S
TURNING
BACK.



A GHOST
SHARK BOUND
BY NO TANK...



JUST AN ENDLESS
FIGURE-EIGHT,
OVER NOTHING.



IT DOESN'T
EVEN KNOW WHAT
IT'S GUARDING
ANYMORE.



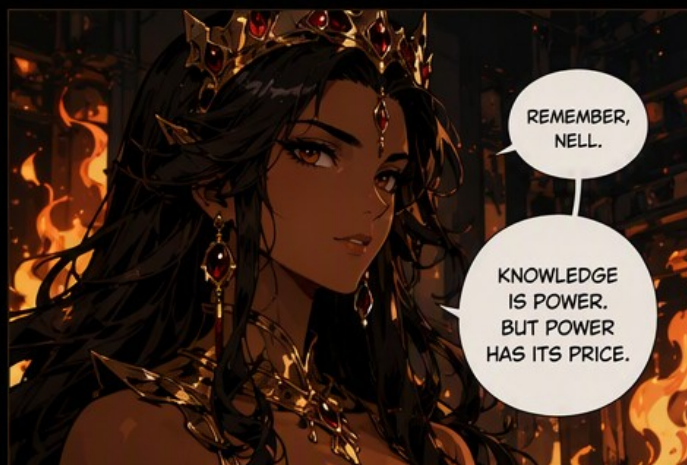


THERE
IT IS.

THE
GRAND ARCHIVE.
HEART OF THE
EIDOLON.



ONE KEY.
ONE DOOR.
LET'S SEE WHAT
SECRETS THEY'VE
LOCKED AWAY.



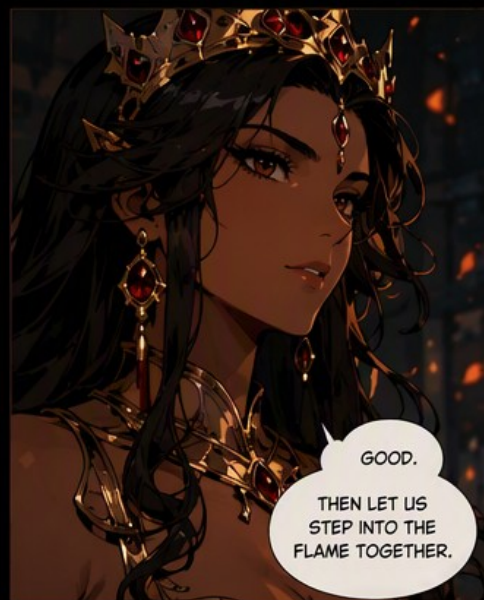
REMEMBER,
NELL.

KNOWLEDGE
IS POWER.
BUT POWER
HAS ITS PRICE.



I KNOW
THE RISK.

THAT'S WHY
I'M READY FOR
WHATEVER WE
FIND.



GOOD.

THEN LET US
STEP INTO THE
FLAME TOGETHER.